

2. The relative pronoun *that* is preferred to 'who' or 'which' in the following cases

Case I After adjectives in the superlative degree.

- e.g. - It is the best movie ~~which~~ / *that* I have ever seen.
 - It is the best food ~~which~~ / *that* I have had for years.

Case II After the following words all, same, any, only, nothing, the only, etc.

- e.g. - It is the same book ~~which~~ / *that* I saw in the market yesterday.
 - All *that* glitters is not gold.
 - It is not for nothing *that* he studied Psychology.

Case III After the interrogative pronouns, 'who' and 'what'.

- e.g. - Who is the girl ~~which~~ / *that* comes in your dreams?
 - What is it *that* you want?

Case IV After two antecedents, one denoting a person and the other denoting an animal or a thing.

- e.g. - The man and his dog *that* had entered the school were turned out.

3. The relative pronoun should be placed as near as possible to its antecedent.

- e.g. - The office was located in the heart of the town *which* had beautiful interior decoration. (X)

- The office, *which* had beautiful interior decoration, was located in the center of the town. (✓)

4. The relative pronoun 'What' is used without any antecedent.

- e.g. - I mean ~~that~~ / *what* I say.
 - ~~That~~ / *What* cannot be cured must be endured.

5. 'Whose' is used to refer to persons only; 'of which' is used while referring to lifeless objects.

- e.g. - I have a friend *whose* father is a doctor.
 - I saw a watch, the dial *of which* was made of gold.

Interrogative Pronouns

The interrogative pronouns are used for making queries or asking questions. The pronoun 'who', 'what' and 'which' are used as interrogative pronouns.

Rules of Interrogative Pronouns

1. 'What' is used in broad sense, while 'Which' is used in the specific sense.
 e.g. - *What* are you doing these days?
 - *Which* institute have you joined for coaching?
2. 'Which' is used in place of 'who' and 'what' when we are referring to a choice between two or among more than two things or persons.
 e.g. - Of the two brothers ~~who~~ / *which* is more intelligent?
 - ~~Who~~ / *Which* is your mother in the crowd?

SPOTTING THE ERRORS SET 2



ERRORS OF PRONOUNS

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-30) Which part of the given sentences has an error? In case, there is no error, choose option (d).

1. The master did not know (a)/ who of the servants (b)/ broke the glass. (c)/ No error (d)
2. The ruling party stood (a)/ for implementation of the bill (b)/ and was ready to stake their political existence. (c)/ No error (d)
3. Wherever they go (a)/ the Indians easily adapt to (b)/ local circumstances. (c)/ No error (d)
4. It is not easy for anyone to command (a)/ respect from one's friends as well as critics (b)/ as Dr. Neil did for his integrity and honesty. (c)/ No error (d)
5. Mahatma Gandhi taught us (a)/ that one should respect (b)/ the religions of others as much as his own. (c)/ No error (d)
6. He, You and I (a)/ shall manage (b)/ this problem together. (c)/ No error (d)
7. Was it him (a)/ who got injured (b)/ in an accident this morning? (c)/ No error (d)
8. As soon as he (a)/ saw his mother (b)/ he ran to her and embraced. (c)/ No error (d)
9. Due to me being a newcomer (a)/ I was unable to get a house (b)/ suitable for my wife and me. (c)/ No error (d)
10. The audience (a)/ are requested (b)/ to be in its seats. (c)/ No error (d)
11. A scientist must follow (a)/ his hunches and his data (b)/ wherever it may lead. (c)/ No error (d)
12. The number of vehicles (a)/ plying on this road (a)/ is more than on the main road. (c)/ No error (d)
13. Being a destitute (a)/ I admitted him (b)/ to an old people's home. (c)/ No error (d)
14. One should make (a)/ his best efforts if one wishes to achieve (b)/ success in this organisation. (c)/ No error (d)
15. May I (a)/ know who you want (b)/ to see please? (c)/ No error (d)

16. Our is the only country (a)/ in the world that can boast of (b)/ unity in diversity. (c)/ No error (d)
17. Last summer he went (a)/ to his uncle's village (b)/ and enjoyed very much. (c)/ No error (d)
18. If I were him (a)/ I would have taught (b)/ those cheats a lesson. (c)/ No error (d)
19. Those sort of people (a)/ usually do not (b)/ earn fame in society. (c)/ No error (d)
20. Had I come (a)/ to know about his difficulties (b)/ I would have certainly helped. (c)/ No error (d)
21. One of them (a)/ forgot to take their bag (b)/ from the school. (c)/ No error (d)
22. Civil servants should (a)/ acquit efficiently (b)/ in the service of a common man. (c)/ No error (d)
23. Avail every chance that comes your way (a)/ lest you should (b)/ repent in the long run. (c)/ No error (d)
24. Let Raj and she (a)/ complete this job (b)/ as they like to do it. (c)/ No error (d)
25. It was with great difficulty (a)/ that each of the brothers (b)/ could get their share of property. (c)/ No error (d)
26. Do you know (a)/ whom all (b)/ are inside the room? (c)/ No error (d)
27. They that run (a)/ after fame and money (b)/ are likely to be disappointed. (c)/ No error (d)
28. One should (a)/ take care of one's belongings (b)/ himself. (c)/ No error (d)
29. God helps those (a)/ who helps (b)/ themselves. (c)/ No error (d)
30. He and her (a)/ went to the party (b)/ in the hotel. (c)/ No error (d)

➤ EXPLANATIONS

1. (b) As the sentence refers to a choice among more than two persons (servants), 'which' will be used in place of 'who'.
2. (c) When a pronoun stands for a collective noun ('ruling party' in the sentence) it must be in the neuter gender. Hence, 'its' will be used in place of 'their'.
3. (b) As the sentence refers to a particular set of people (Indians), it will contain a reflexive pronoun 'themselves' after 'adapt'.
4. (b) In this sentence, the pronoun 'one's' is missing before the word 'critics'. Hence, we will add 'one's' before 'critics'.
5. (c) The given sentence has an indefinite pronoun 'one'. As per the rule, 'his' should be replaced with 'one's' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
6. (a) As per the rule, the second person should come before the third and the third person comes before the first. So, the correct order will be : 'You, he and I.....'
7. (a) As per the rule, the component of the verb 'to be' (was) when expressed by a pronoun should be in the nominative case. Hence, 'him' in the sentence will be replaced by 'he'.
8. (c) The sentence is incomplete as it does not answer the question 'whom did he embrace?' So, we will add 'her' at the end of the sentence.
9. (a) The pronoun 'me' used in part (a) of the sentence is incorrect. It should be replaced by 'I'.
10. (c) As the sentence refers to living beings ('audience'), the pronoun 'its' will be replaced by 'their'.
11. (c) The pronoun 'it' is incorrectly used in the sentence. It should be replaced by 'they' as the sentence refers to 'his hunches' and 'his data'.
12. (c) The sentence does not have 'that' after 'than'. So, to make the sentence meaningful 'that' should be added after 'than'.
13. (a) The sentence does not convey the intended meaning as it has 'He' missing in the beginning. So, the correct sentence would start as 'He being a destitute'
14. (b) As the sentence begins with an Indefinite pronoun 'one', it should not have 'his' in the sentence. Hence, we replace 'his' by 'one's' to make the sentence correct.
15. (b) The pronoun 'who' would be replaced by 'whom' to make the sentence meaningful.
16. (a) The reflexive pronoun 'Ours' will be used in the sentence instead of 'Our' to make the sentence correct.
17. (c) The reflexive pronoun 'himself' would be used after the word 'enjoyed' to make the sentence meaningful.
18. (a) The verb 'were' when expressed by a pronoun, it should be in the nominative case. Hence, 'he' would be used instead of 'him'.
19. (a) 'Sort of' is incorrect. It should be replaced by 'sorts of' to make the sentence correct.
20. (c) The sentence is incomplete as it does not answer the question 'helped whom?'. So, we add 'him' at the end of the sentence.
21. (b) 'Their' should be replaced by 'his' to make the sentence correct.
22. (b) The pronoun 'themselves' should come after 'acquit'.
23. (a) 'Yourself of' needs to be added after 'Avail' to make the sentence correct.
24. (a) 'She' should be replaced by 'her' to make the sentence correct.
25. (c) 'Each of' takes a singular pronoun. So, 'their' should be replaced by 'his'.
26. (b) 'Whom' should be replaced by 'who'.
27. (a) 'They' needs to be replaced by 'Those'.
28. (c) 'Himself' should be replaced by 'oneself'.
29. (b) 'Helps' should be replaced by 'help' to make the sentence grammatically correct.
30. (a) 'Her' would be replaced by 'she' to make the sentence error free.

VERB

A verb is a word (such as jump, think, happen or exist) that is usually one of the main parts of a sentence and that expresses an action, an occurrence, or a state of being.

Classification of Verbs

Verbs can be classified as following

1. Main Verbs

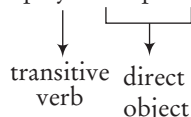
Main verbs have meanings related to actions, events and states. Most verbs in English are main verbs. e.g. go, show, exist, etc.

Main verbs can be divided into two categories; transitive and intransitive which are as follow

(i) Transitive Verbs

A transitive verb is a verb that can take a direct object.

e.g. She played the piano.



(ii) Intransitive Verbs

An Intransitive verb has two characteristics. *First*, it is an action verb expressing a double activity like arrive, go, lie, sneeze, sit, die, etc. *Second*, unlike a transitive verb, it will not have a direct object receiving the action.

Intransitive verbs have the pattern N + V (Noun + Verb). The clause is complete without anything else.

e.g. - John *smiled*.
- Nothing *happened*.

Here, 'smiled' and 'happened' are intransitive verbs.

Linking Verbs

Some main verbs are called Linking Verbs. These verbs are not followed by objects. Instead they are followed by phrases which give extra information about the subject. Linking verbs include appear, feel, look, seem, sound, smell, taste, become, etc.

e.g. - A face *appeared* at the window.

In this sentence, 'appeared' is the linking verb and 'at the window' is the phrase.

2. Auxiliary Verbs

Auxiliary verbs can be divided into two categories; primary and modal auxiliary verbs, which are as follow

(i) Primary Auxiliary Verbs

Primary auxiliary verbs can further be divided as following

- i. Verbs 'to be' : is, am, are, was, were, will be, shall be
- ii. Verbs 'to have' : have, has, had
- iii. Verbs 'to do' : do, does, did

(ii) Modal Auxiliary Verbs

Modal auxiliary verbs denote the mood/mode of the subject. They are can, could, may, might, should, used to, need, dare, etc.

Tenses

There are three basic tenses : Present, Past and Future.

These can further be divided into the following segments

1. **Simple** The action is mentioned simply. Nothing is said about whether the action is complete or not.
2. **Continuous** The action is incomplete or is going on at the time of speaking.
3. **Perfect** The action is finished or complete with respect to a certain point of time.
4. **Perfect Continuous** The action is going on continuously over a long period of time and is yet to be finished.

Simple Present

(He, She, It, Single name — $V_1 + s, es$)

(They, you, I, Plurals— V_1)

- To express a habitual action.
e.g. - He *goes* for a walk in the morning.
- It *rains* in winter in Tamil Nadu.
- He often *gets* late for dinner.
- To express universal truths.
e.g. - The sun *rises* in the East.
- Two and two *make* four.
- In exclamatory sentences beginning with 'here' and 'there', to express what is actually taking place in the present.
e.g. - Here he *comes*!
- There *goes* the train!
- To indicate a future event that is part of a plan or an arrangement.
e.g. - PM *comes* to the town next month.
- The Indian team *goes* to England this month.
- To introduce quotations.
e.g. - Gita *says*, "Give your best and do not worry for the results".
- Pope *says*, "A little knowledge is a dangerous thing".

Present Continuous

(Is / Am / Are + $V_1 + ing$)

- To express an action going on at the time of speaking.
e.g. - I am *studying* in the class.

- To express a temporary action which may not be actually happening at the time of speaking.
e.g. - I am *preparing* for the competition.
- I am *working* on a project.
- It also represents future action or a definite arrangement in the near future.
e.g. - I am *going* to Mumbai tomorrow.
- He is *coming* tonight.
- When the reference is to a particular obstinate habit, the present continuous is used instead of present simple. An adverb, like always, constantly, etc, is also used.
e.g. - It is no use scolding him, he ~~always does~~ / is *always doing* what is forbidden.
- The following verbs are normally used in the present simple instead of present continuous
 - (a) Verbs of Appearance** Look, appear, seem.
 - (b) Verbs of Emotion** Want, wish, desire, feel, like, love, hate, hope, prefer, etc.
 - (c) Verbs of Perception** See, hear, smell, taste, notice, recognise, etc.
 - (d) Verbs of Possession** Belong to, consist of, contain, own, etc.
 - (e) Verbs of Thinking** Agree, believe, consider, forget, imagine, know, mind, remember, etc.

Present Perfect (*Has / Have + V₃*)

- It is used to indicate completed activities in the immediate past. It is a mixture of present and past. It always implies a strong connection of past with the present.
e.g. - He *has* just *gone* out.
- The most important point is that it is used with the past actions whose time is not given and not definite.
e.g. - He *came* here. (X)
- He *has come* here. (✓)
- He *came* here yesterday. (✓)
- It is used with the adverbs like ever, just, recently, already, yet, so far, of late, lately, by the time, for, etc.
e.g. - He *has already* finished the work.
- *Recently*, he *has* started working on a new project.
- I *have just seen* that film.
- It is the best book that I *have ever read*.
- I *have known* him *for* twenty years.
- He *has started* coming late *lately*.
- He *hasn't paid* the bill *so far*.
- It can never be used with the words like last, ago, yesterday, before, back, formerly, fixed time, etc.
e.g. - He *has come* here yesterday. (X)
- He *came* here yesterday. (✓)
- India *has won* last year. (X)
- India *won* last year. (✓)

Present Perfect Continuous

(*Have been/Has been + V₁ + ing*)

- To express an action which began at sometime in the past and is still continuing.
e.g. - He is *playing* since 8 o'clock. (X)
- He *has been playing* since 8 o'clock. (✓)
- They *have been writing* since morning. (✓)

Simple Past (*V₂*)

- To indicate an action completed in the past at a definite time.
e.g. - I *did* this. (X)
- I *have* done this. (✓)
- I *did* this yesterday. (✓)
- Denoted by last, ago, yesterday, back, before, formerly, any fixed time, etc.
e.g. - We *heard* a terrifying news *last* night.
- They *celebrated* the occasion two days *ago*.
- He *inherited* his father's business *after* his father's demise.
- The train *didn't* arrive on time *yesterday*.
- She *didn't* go there *in the morning*.
- To indicate past habits, indicated generally by the words like often, seldom, never, normally, generally, always, frequently, rarely, daily, used to, etc.
e.g. - As a kid, I *often went* to school on foot.
- My friend *frequently visited* his hometown in the past.
- I *seldom wrote* a cheque even when there was balance in my account.
- *Whenever* I *called* on him he *pretended* to be ill.
- He *always carried* a stick when he *went* for a walk.
- After 'it is time'
e.g. - It is time Indian cricket team ~~*starts*~~ / *started* winning test matches.



- The conjunction **since** denotes present time dating back to some event. It is therefore, followed by a Simple Past Tense and preceded by some form of Present Perfect Tense.
e.g. Many things have happened since I have left the school. (X)
Many things have happened since I left the school. (✓)

Past Continuous (*Was/Were + V₁ + ing*)

- To denote an action going on at some time in the past.
e.g. - When I went to his house, he *was playing*.
- I *was studying* yesterday.
- For persistent habits in the past.
e.g. - He *was* always *mooching* around.

Past Perfect (*Had* + V_3)

- To describe an action completed before a certain moment in the past.
 - e.g. - I met him in New Delhi in 2000. I *had seen* him last five years before. (✓)
 - It *had rained* yesterday. (X)
 - It *rained* yesterday. (✓)
 - My friend *had come* to visit me. (X)
 - My friend *came* to visit me yesterday. (✓)
- Past perfect should be used only when we wish to say that one action got completed before the other started. It should never be used at all in any other sense.
 - e.g. - I *went* to Mumbai. (X)
 - I *had gone* to Mumbai (X)
 - Ravi *had* walked two miles by lunch time. (✓)
 - I *had gone* to Mumbai when he *came* to meet me. (✓)

Past Perfect Continuous (*Had been* + $V_1 + ing$)

- To express an action that began before a certain point of time in the past and continued upto that time.
 - e.g. - He *had been studying* for two hours when his girlfriend came.
 - Tendulkar *had been* playing for eleven years when his toe got injured.
- If there is Past tense in the Principal clause, it must be followed by a Past tense in the Dependent clause. In an Indirect narration, the Simple Past in the Dependent clause is changed to Past Perfect, if the Principal clause is in the Past tense.
 - e.g. - He told me that he *intended* to start a business. (X)
 - He told me that he *had intended* to start a business. (✓)
 - He hinted that he *tried* to save him. (X)
 - He hinted that he *had tried* to save him. (✓)
- The exception to the above rule is if some universal, habitual or generally recognised fact is mentioned in the Dependent clause, the Present tense must be retained in all conditions.
 - e.g. - He told me that the Earth *moves* round the Sun.
 - His illness convinced me that all men *are* mortal.

Simple Future (*Shall / Will* + V_1)

- To express an action that is still to take place.
 - e.g. - I *shall go* for the preparation when I shall receive the call letter. (X)
 - I *shall go* for the preparation when I *receive* the call letter. (✓)

Future Continuous (*Shall be / Will be* + $V_1 + ing$)

- To express an action as going on at some time in the future.
 - e.g. - I *shall be earning* when I *shall* be 21. (X)
 - I *shall be earning* when I am 21. (✓)

Future Perfect (*Shall have / Will have* + V_3)

- To indicate the completion of an action by a certain future time.
 - e.g. - We *shall have completed* our syllabus by next month.
 - I *shall have done* this work by tomorrow.

Future Perfect Continuous(*Will have been / Shall have been* + $V_1 + ing$)

- To indicate an action which is in progress over a period of time and will be in progress at a certain time in future.
 - e.g. - Tendulkar *will have been playing* for India for 20 years when he completes the age of 35.
 - Time *will have been clocking* for ages in the coming moments.

Subject-Verb Agreement

- If two subjects together express one idea, one being added to the other for the sake of emphasis or clarification, the verb is singular. No plurality is left to exist in such a case.
 - e.g. - Slow and steady *wins* the race.
 - Bread and butter *is* essential for one's existence.
- When the plural noun denotes some specific quantity, distance, time or amount considered as a whole, the verb *is* generally singular.
 - e.g. - Six miles *is* not a long distance for me.
 - Ten lakh *is* equivalent to a million.
- Two or more singular subjects connected by 'either-or', 'neither-nor', take a verb in singular (third person singular verb).
 - e.g. - *Either* Vivek *or* Vimal *is* absent today.
 - He asked me if *either* of the applicants *was* suitable.
 - *Either* you *or* I *shall / will* go to the party.
- When the subjects joined by 'or' or 'nor' are of different numbers, the verb must be plural and the plural subject must be placed next to the verb.
 - e.g. - *Either* Amit *or* his parents *are* coming to the party.